Oliver Donaldson

Engaging | Capable | Curious | Reliable

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PROFILE

Engaging, capable and commercially minded student at Victoria University of Wellington, with experience across premium hospitality, financial services, coaching and student leadership. I connect easily with people and take ownership: three years looking after travellers in a busy airport lounge, a FinTech internship where I improved an operational process, and years coaching sailors from first-timers to racing squads. Reliable, curious and quick to learn, I'd bring energy to a hospitality, retail, customer experience or commerce team.

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Great with people:** three years looking after travellers in a premium lounge; quick rapport with guests and families
- **Clear communicator:** coached complete beginners through to racing squads, adapting to each person's confidence and learning style
- **Initiative and ownership:** co-founded an award-winning Young Enterprise business at school; at Harmoney, helped replace a manual process handling 70–80 customer requests a month
- **Leadership:** College Communications Prefect at St Peter's; class representative for two university papers; VicAI committee member; led sailing programmes for groups of all ages
- **Reliable under pressure:** three years on a fixed weekend roster alongside full-time study; calm and accurate at peak times
- **Quick to learn:** moved from law into data science; confident with new systems and helping others with them

EXPERIENCE

Catering Assistant | *Compass Group NZ / Air New Zealand Lounge, Wellington Airport* Sep 2023 – Present

- Work across bar and barista, kitchen hand and catering roles, so I can step in wherever the lounge needs me.
- Deliver warm, efficient service to travellers in a premium, high-volume lounge, keeping the guest experience friendly, accurate and polished during peak periods.
- Prepare, present and replenish food to a high standard while responding promptly to guest needs and supporting the wider team wherever required.
- Maintain a fixed weekend roster alongside full-time study, showing consistency, time management and a strong work ethic.

AI & Analytics Intern | *Harmoney, Financial Services* Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

- Improved a customer-facing loan-closure process, replacing manual work that handled 70–80 requests a month with an automated confirmation and a self-service download page, with an audit trail behind every letter.
- Built clear reporting for the Finance team and worked across Operations, customer and technical requirements, turning detailed problems into practical outcomes.

Sailing Coach | *Royal Akarana Yacht Club* May 2019 – Jan 2024

- Led safe, engaging programmes across age groups, from complete beginners to competitive racing squads, building a positive team environment centred on confidence, progress, enjoyment and responsibility.
- Built trust with sailors and families, explained skills clearly and adapted my approach to different personalities, confidence levels and learning styles.

EDUCATION & LEADERSHIP

BSc Data Science | *Victoria University of Wellington* 2024 – Expected 2027

Class Representative | *LAWS 297 and STAT 292, Victoria University of Wellington* 2025

Co-founder, SailSaver | *Young Enterprise Scheme* 2023

- Turned old sails into tote bags and donated 25% of profits; won Excellence in Business Management for central Auckland at the YES Tāmaki Makaurau Regional Awards.

College Communications Prefect | *St Peter's College, Epsom* 2023

- Led the prefect team's internal communications and started the St Peter's College Speak podcast. University Entrance with NCEA Level 3 and Level 2 Excellence endorsements; passed University of Auckland PHIL 105 Critical Thinking (B+) through the Young Scholars Programme while at school.

Youth Training Programme | *Royal New Zealand Yacht Squadron* 2022

- Selected for the Mastercard Youth Training Programme; represented the Squadron at the Harken Youth International Match Racing Cup, reaching the quarterfinals and finishing 6th.

INTERESTS

Sailing · Fishing · Football · Running · Cooking · Snorkelling and camping · Fitness (NZIFBB natural bodybuilding competitor, 2025)

I love meeting new people, travelling and staying active, from coaching a sailing crew to finding a great local eatery. In my spare time I built a live website that uses NASA telescope data to find likely planets.